

Link Building Still Works for AI Answers

What a 1,000 domain study found.

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The question

Do backlinks still matter when AI answers the question directly?

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The finding

Authority still correlates with being cited. Links are how the model decides who to trust.

What changed

Brand mentions and named sources now carry weight alongside the link itself.

The shift

A mention in a trusted source can matter as much as a followed link.

What to build

Relationships and original data, not a spreadsheet of paid placements.

Do this

Audit who mentions you versus who links to you. Save this.